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EUROPE IN TURMOIL

STARMER FLIES INTO A STORM

**Anger as PM rejects calls for urgent boost
to defence spending ahead of crisis summit
in Paris today — and showdown with Trump**

SIR Keir Starmer has refused to urgently boost military spending amid a defence crisis in Europe.

Government sources said he was still planning to spend 2.5 per cent of GDP on the Armed Forces — despite pressing calls to

By **Martin Beckford**
Policy Editor

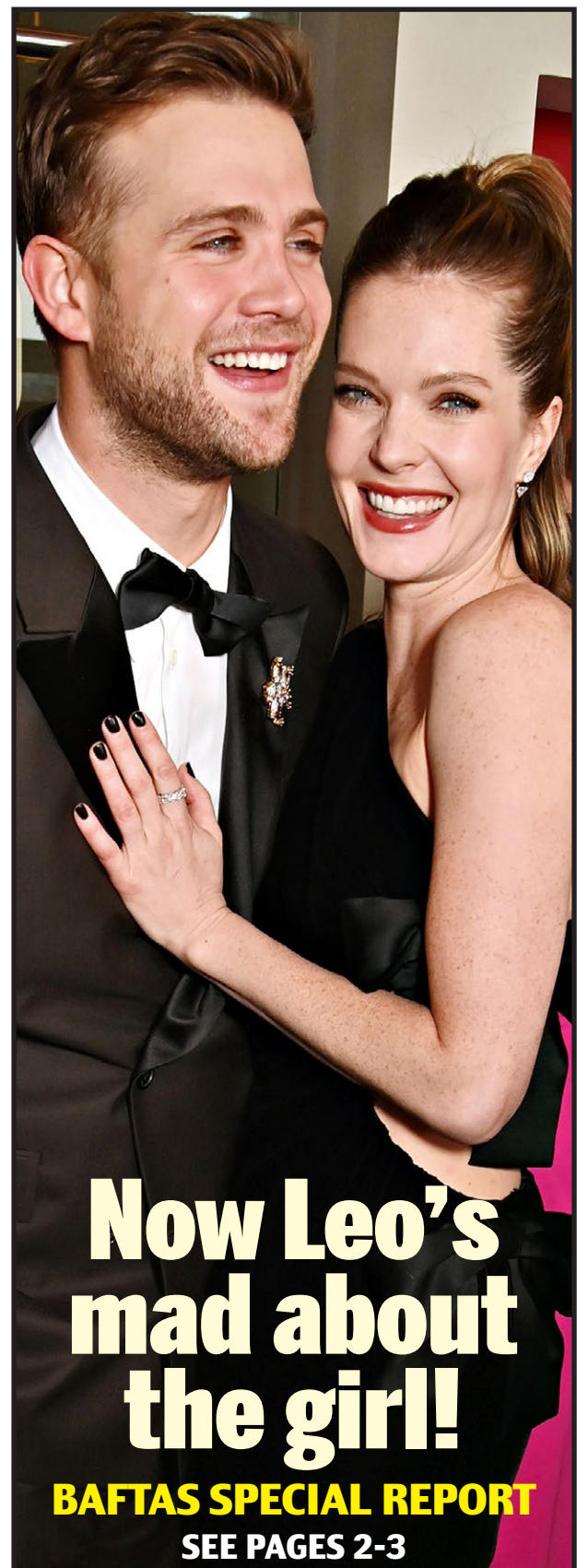
go beyond that figure — and that the timetable for reaching his goal would not be accelerated.

It comes as the Prime Minister flies today to Paris for a crisis summit on Donald Trump's shock plan for peace talks with Vladimir Putin

— and after the watershed security conference in Munich where the US warned Europe it must stop relying on Washington to boost its security.

The summit will take place at the same time US and Russian officials meet in Saudi Arabia to negotiate an end to the Ukraine war — without Kyiv or Europe present. Sir Keir

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**Now Leo's
mad about
the girl!**

BAFTAS SPECIAL REPORT

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